

- Dip the bottoms of plastic utensils in glue and glitter, then arrange in a mason jar on the food table.
- Cut out a cardboard shape that represents the age the birthday boy or girl is turning, and cover with scrunched tissue paper.
- Attach star-shaped (or any other theme) stickers to the tops of lollipop sticks, and use them in place of an expensive cake topper.

The possibilities are endless when you stop and think about it. But if you don't have time to make your own decorations, a quick trip to the dollar store for party streamers and balloons will turn any space into a party setting for cheap.

5. SIGN UP FOR FREEBIES

Birthdays don't always have to be celebrated at home. In fact, sometimes it's cheaper to go out, thanks to a variety of retail and restaurant birthday freebies! You'll want to sign up for them at least thirty days before your birthday to be eligible, then print and keep on hand to enjoy free stuff throughout your birthday month.

READER TIP:

Firehouse Subs gives you a free sub on your birthday—you don't have to have a coupon or be on their email club—all you need is your ID!

—Eileen, FL

Here are a few of my favorite examples:

- **Auntie Anne's** – FREE pretzel on your birthday. I think the Cinnamon Sugar ones are the best!
- **CVS** – \$3 Extra Bucks if you belong to the Beauty Club.